SOCIAL FINANCE

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Data and Tech Standards for Children's Social Care

Placement Standards Working Group 2

17th September 2025

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PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

Things to be aware of

Conflicts of interest – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk.

Anti-competitive activities – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk of anti-competitive activity.

Intellectual Property - If you are concerned about the use of your contributions, please contact the secretariat.

Meeting Recording - We will record this meeting and using AI transcription tools.

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Principles for group

1. Every voice matters
2. Please join in on the conversation, we don’t want this to be one way
3. If you’re happy to, keep your camera on
4. Please raise your hand if you want to come in, or drop your ideas in the chat
5. Respect the diverse viewpoints in the room, assume positive intent and remain open for different experiences

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Agenda

1. Reminder – what are we setting out to do?
2. What progress have we made since we last met?
3. What decisions have been made
4. What’s left to do to finalise the standard
5. What else should we be considering?

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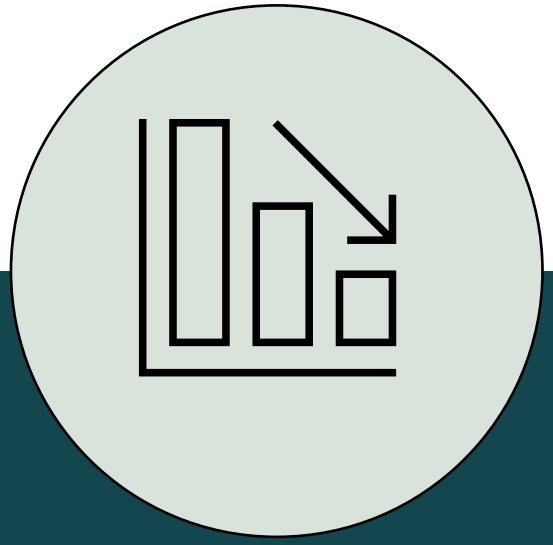
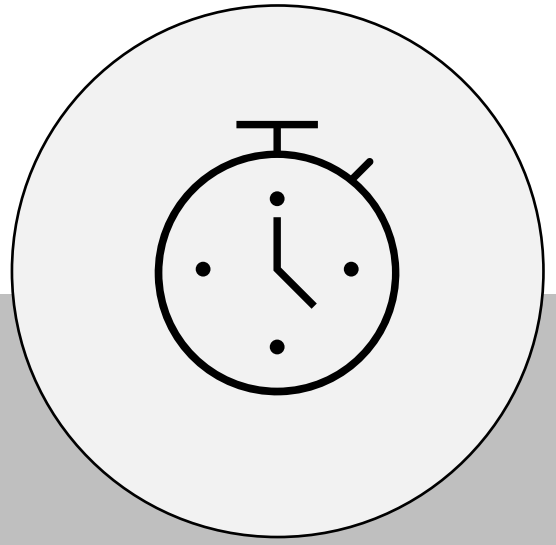
Reminder - Programme Overview

We're interested in using standards to drive four key benefits:

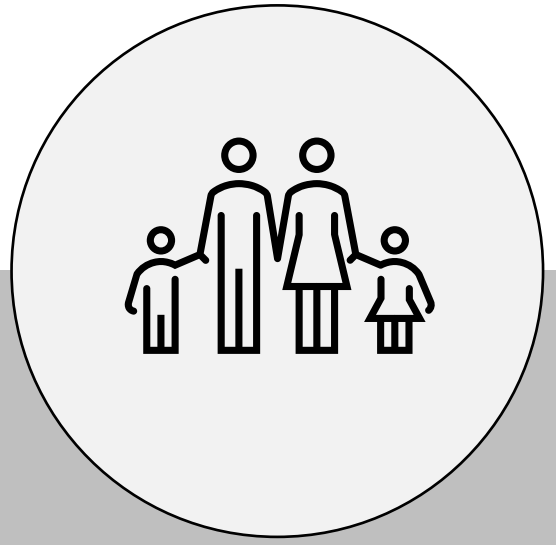
Improved data sharing to support safeguarding decisions



Better data analysis and strategic decision making



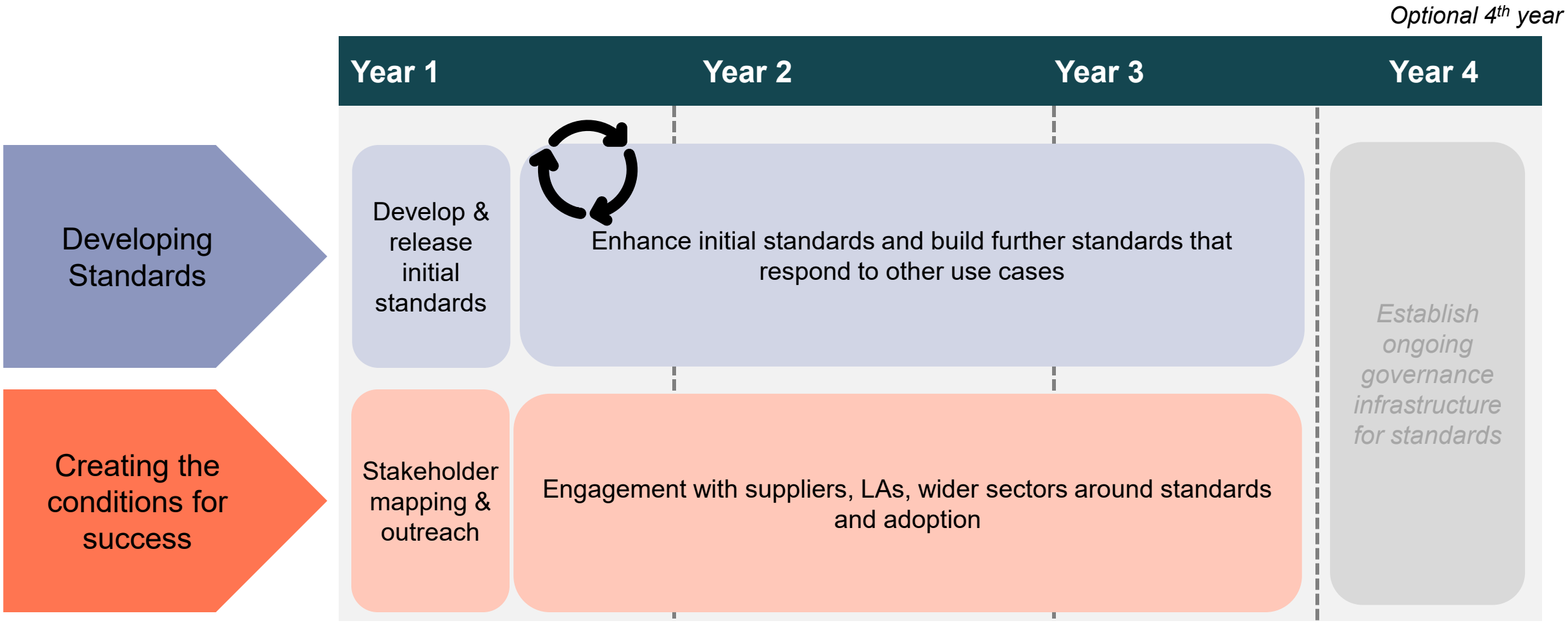
Improved productivity for social workers and a reduction in tech inhibiting processes



Increased power sharing with children and families

FOCUS FOR THIS GROUP

What might the next 3 years look like to help us solve the problems in the market using standards?



Our placements roadmap, based on your input to date

NOW (decided by Steering Committee)	NEXT (Based on your input last time; will finalise at a future session)	AT SOME POINT (Long list of use cases based on Working Group input)
Better Sufficiency Analysis *What provision where, at what cost and at what notice would help us meet the unmet demand and what is the business case for creating this provision?*	*Supporting approaches to standardising child need assessments?* *Understanding provider pricing models?* *Better analysis of what could reduce demand?*	*Home search* *Outcomes tracking* *Contract monitoring* *Fostering supply* *Forecasting future need* *What else…?*

Who is here today?

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Where are you dialling in from?

fast
bold
creative
inspiration
leader
focus
transpiration

0/1

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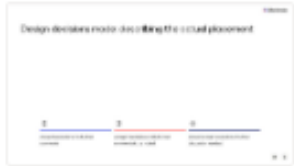
Placement Standard W...

Choose a slide to present



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What type of organisation are you representing?

Central Govt	Local Authority	Regional group	IFA or Resi Care Provider	Tech or Software Supplier	VCSE	Other
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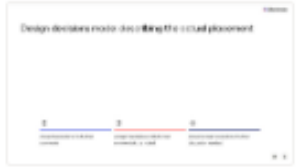

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What is your role?

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Social Worker / Principle SW	Data Analytics / Reporting / Performance	Data Management or Governance	Commissioner / Strategic Commissioner	Director / Leadership	System Change / System Transformation Lead	Other

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Placement Standard W...

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Progress we've made so far

Reminder: proposed objectives for Placement Standard workstream

So that…

1. **Standard Dramatically Improves Sufficiency Analysis**

   LAs can answer: **what type of provision is needed where and in what volumes**? And what is the business case for doing it in each LA (or in partnership)?

2. **Standard Is Easy to Adopt**

   Placements teams can **enter the data in 90 seconds** or less

3. **Implementation Support is Effective and Affordable**

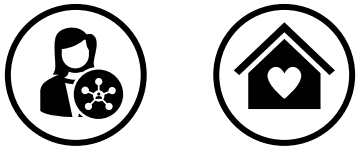
   LAs are able to implement and **benefit from a new standard quickly** within existing resource

Process for reaching resolving each design issue

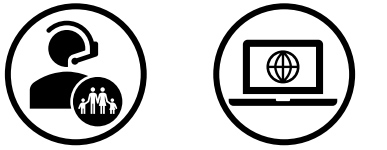
1. Working Group invited to **build out the 'long list'** of deep dive issues
2. Programme team gathers and **consolidates all comments** raised on each issue, ensuring input from all key perpsectives
4. Attendees at **Deep Dive reach position** to feed back to wider Working Group
3. If there is consensus, **Working Group endorses** and recommends to Steering Committee
5. **Standard remains open** on Github for comments (to review standard periodically)

For each decision, we're testing our thinking against these criteria & perspectives

SCOPE
Does it help us answer key sufficiency questions?



FEASIBILTY
Can it be gathered in <90 seconds without requiring change from CMS vendors?



ADDITIONALITY
Are we sure we're not duplicating existing data?

OTHER IMPACTS
Are we sure there are no unintended impacts?

Where are we up to?

Resolved in Deep Dives

- ✓ **Refined** how we describe the actual placement
- ✓ **Refined** how we describe placement requirements and child needs

Further discussions and testing needed

- ➢ **Test (via github)** a ‘silver/gold’ expansion to the standard that notes individual placement priorities
- ➢ **Engage CYP** input on whether/how to describe actual placements (to ensure we understand what matters most)
- ➢ **Engage Providers** to test list of determinants of availability

Still to be discussed in Deep Dives

- ? Describing **location**
- ? Describing **placement costs**
- ? Expanding **scope to drivers of reduced** demand (e.g. reason for referral, reasons for disrupted placement)
- ? **Implementation** and adoption
- ? **Quality assurance**
- ? *….?*

Decisions Log – Describing the actual placement

Issue	Key perspectives	Issue discussed	Resolution agreed
Describing the actual placement	Commissioners and DCSs; Providers and IFAs	• Actual placements described by: Location, Type, Provider URN, and whether siblings were split up • Discussed whether this was the right list for commissioners to understand sufficiency gaps at a high level	• **Explore further** adding an option to specify top 3 priorities for placement and whether they were achieved to include in a 'silver/gold' version of the standard (rather than in the MVP)
Describing Placement type	Commissioners and DCSs; Providers and IFAs; Performance, data & tech leads; Placement workers	• Placement type described by list: Foster, Residential, Supported Accommodation. • Is this list sufficient for commissioners to understand gap between ideal and actual placement type?	• **Add** external / internal distinction • **Explore further** whether we add regulated / unregulated distinction, noting possible practicality constraints
Describing if siblings were split	Commissioners and DCSs; Placement workers; Children & Family Voice	• Whether siblings were split is described by options: Y/N • Is the description of whether siblings were split up (a) able to be gathered by placement workers and (b) granular enough to be useful?	• **Change** 'where siblings split' to 'How many siblings were placed together' • **Add** 'Where there was a sibling group, was placement according to plan' with options: 'Yes, No, N/A'

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Design decisions made: describing the actual placement

0	0	0
Accept resolutions. No further comments	Accept resolutions. with further comments to be noted.	Do not accept resolutions. Further discussion needed.

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MG

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If you do not accept the Deep Dive resolutions, why not (please add your initials)

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

0 / 1

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Placement Standard W...

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Decisions Log – Describing what determines placement availability

Issue	Key perspectives	Issue discussed	Resolution agreed
Describing Placement requirements	Commissioners and DCSs; Placement workers; Performance, data & tech leads; Providers and IFAs	• This section captures what providers told us in initial testing what matters most when deciding to offer placement • Is it this list (a) practical for a placement worker to gather this information and (b) sufficiently nuanced for commissioners to understand drivers of placement availability	• **Drop** 'preferred staffing ratio' • **Change** 'can child live with pets' drop down to 'yes-must, yes-can, no, not known' • **Further test** list of placement requirement determinants of availability with providers.
Describing Risks to child and others	Commissioners and DCSs; Placement workers; Performance, data & tech leads; Providers and IFAs	• This section captures what providers told us in initial testing what matters most when deciding to offer placement • Is it this list (a) practical for a placement worker to gather this information and (b) sufficiently nuanced for commissioners to understand drivers of placement availability	• **Add** DOL (not yet user tested) • **Change** drop down for risks to 'no known risk' / 'risk present' • **Further test** list of risks with providers (e.g. via survey)

Decisions Log – Describing the actual placement

Issue	Resolution agreed	% Working Group accepting resolution
Describing the actual placement	• **Explore further** adding an option to specify top 3 priorities for placement and whether they were achieved to include in a 'silver/gold' version of the standard (rather than in the MVP)	81%
Describing Placement type	• **Add** external / internal distinction • **Explore further** whether we add regulated / unregulated distinction, noting possible practicality constraints	
Describing if siblings were split	• **Change** 'where siblings split' to 'How many siblings were placed together' • **Add** 'Where there was a sibling group, was placement according to plan' with options: 'Yes, No, N/A'	
Describing Placement requirements	• **Drop** 'preferred staffing ratio' • **Change** 'can child live with pets' drop down to 'yes-must, yes-can, no, not known' • **Further test** list of placement requirement determinants of availability with providers.	88%
Describing Risks to child and others	• **Add** DOL (not yet user tested) • **Change** drop down for risks to 'no known risk' / 'risk present' • **Further test** list of risks with providers (e.g. via survey)	

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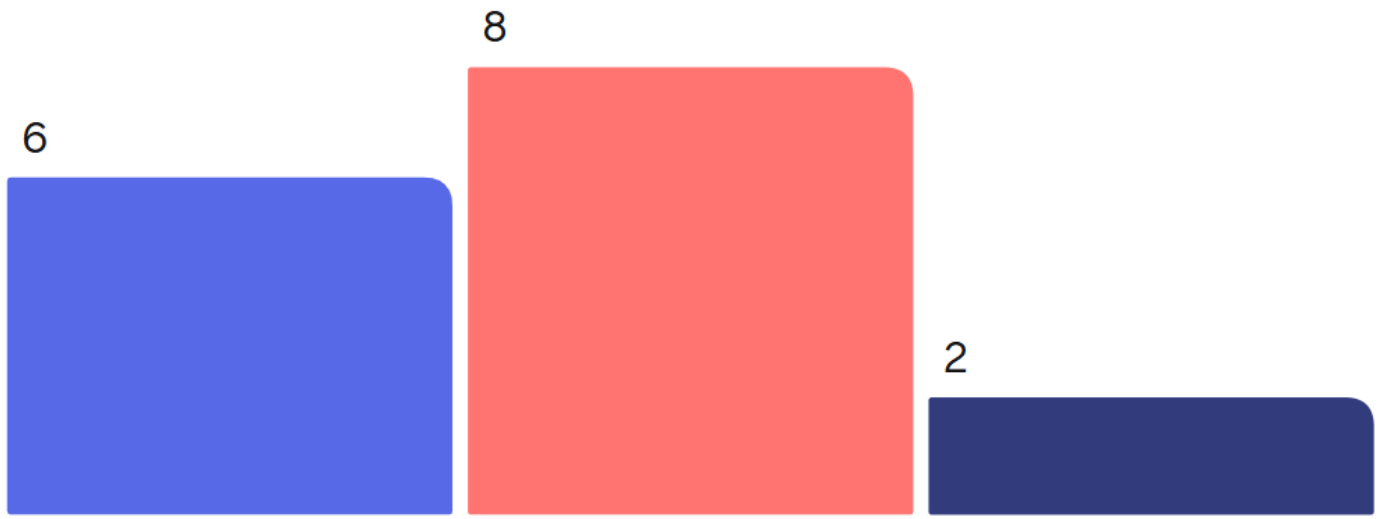
Design decisions made: what determines placement availability?



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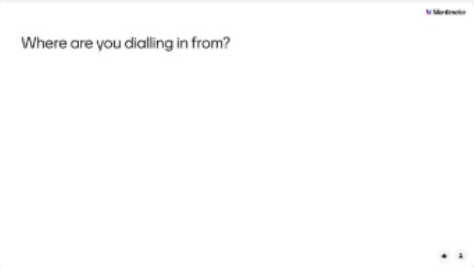

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If you do not accept the Deep Dive resolutions, why not? (please add your initials)

More information required as to whether a risk is current or historic

I accepted but one suggestion - can we add how the needs have been assessed?

I think you won't get the results you want. Need to note what ideal result is for placement v what you got and why

Comment around recording of risk which would seem to be key to sufficiency considerations where the details about placement options are defined by the risks DM

4

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Placement Standard W...

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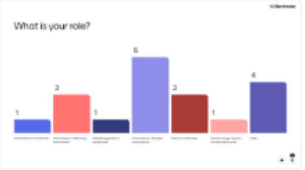

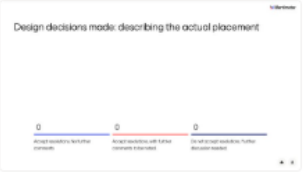

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What other design questions do we need to cover before we finalise the standard?

Do we need to break down the different elements of support that are being put in via placement offers? Such as 2:1, therapy etc? Or is that level of detail not required?

Common need descriptors

A session covering the testing done in the South West and what has been learned from it so that we can all be on the same page in terms of what this data standard is and how it can be used

Do we need to capture something on the placement search approach itself?

What behaviours are we wanting to change with the the new data requirements, i.e what is the change we want to see? JT

Any tie ins to current locality or regional work and specifically can this lend itself to sufficiency modelling

6

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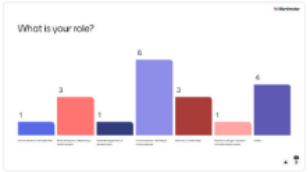

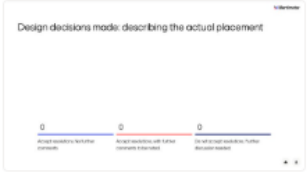

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What's working well in the design process so far?

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

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What could we change about the process so far?

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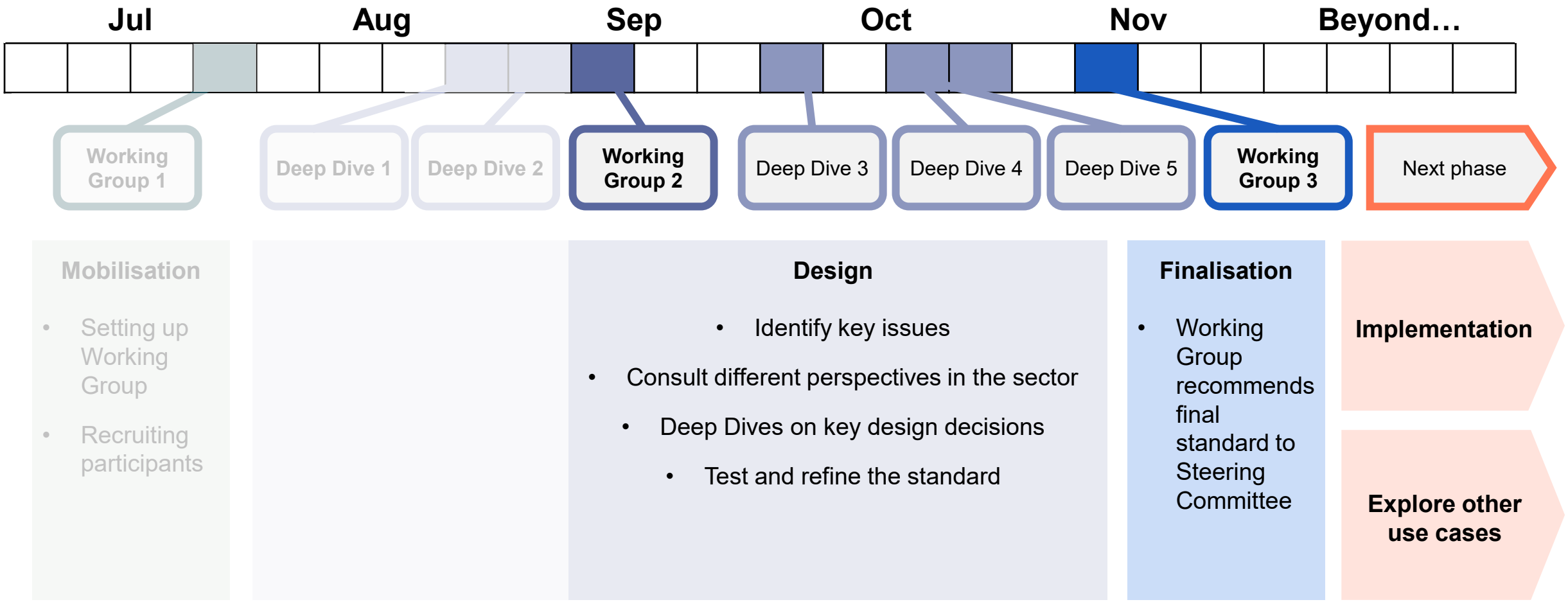
Where are we up to?



APPENDIX